



Outbound vs. inbound marketing

Outbound marketing interrupts consumers to promote a product or brand, but inbound marketing needs consumers' permission—they have to seek out information that leads to the marketing message.

How it works

Before the rise of the internet and the phenomenon of social media, most marketing strategies were outbound. In other words, marketers pushed messages at consumers by interrupting them with advertisements or direct mail. The same principle applies to outbound marketing that appears on the internet, with pop-up ads

interrupting the content the consumer wishes to access. However, because consumers from all over the world now use the internet to search for information and entertainment, marketers have adopted inbound strategies instead, providing content that draws the consumer to the brand or product, rather than pushing marketing messages at them.

NEED TO KNOW

- **Push or interruption-based**
Alternative marketing terms used to describe outbound marketing
- **Pull or permission-based**
Alternative marketing terms used to describe inbound marketing

Pros and cons

Marketers interrupt consumers with hundreds of outbound marketing messages every day, but they also use subtle inbound marketing tactics to attract consumers. Each strategy has its advantages and drawbacks.

